UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

THURSDAY, 01 OCTOBER 2026

21 must-know stories, 25 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 13 explainers, picked from 916 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

ECI appointments case: J. Datta asks petitioner to mention before CJI his plea to recall split verdict

The petitioner moved the Supreme Court seeking the recall of Justice Sharma's opinion concerning the reference of the constitutional validity challenge of the 2023 Act. Justice Datta asked a petitioner to mention before the Chief Justice of India a plea seeking to recall a split verdict opinion regarding the reference of the ECI appointments law challenge to a five-judge bench. The petitioner seeks recall of Justice Sharma’s opinion ruling on referring the constitutional validity challenge of the CEC and ECI (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, to a five-judge bench

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justice Datta, Justice Sharma, Petitioner · **Prelims:** The Act in question is the CEC and ECI (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023.; The plea seeks to recall Justice Sharma's opinion.; The matter involves a reference to a five-judge bench.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights procedural mechanisms in the Supreme Court regarding split verdicts and bench references.; Crucial for understanding judicial oversight of legislative enactments governing election commission appointments.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India is the highest judicial forum and final court of appeal under the Constitution of India. Under Article 145(3) of the Constitution, cases involving a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution are heard by a bench of at least five judges. A split verdict occurs when a two-judge bench delivers differing opinions, requiring the matter to be referred to a larger bench.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules, Appointment

The Hindu: read the source · also reported by scconline.com, Times of India, Hindustan Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Section 24 of the Land Acquisition Act 2013: Supreme Court Constitution Bench Settles the Law on Deemed Lapse of Acquisition Proceedings

The matter was in the news due to the Constitution Bench delivering its final judgment resolving conflicting interpretations of Section 24(2). The Supreme Court Constitution Bench settled the legal position regarding the deemed lapse of land acquisition proceedings under Section 24 of the Land Acquisition Act 2013.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court Constitution Bench · **Prelims:** The statute involved is the Land Acquisition Act 2013.; The specific provision in question is Section 24.; The bench that settled the law is the Supreme Court Constitution Bench.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Settles conflicting judicial precedents on land acquisition and compensation laws.; Provides legal certainty for pending infrastructure development projects nationwide.*

Static — The Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act 2013 replaced the colonial-era Land Acquisition Act of 1894. Section 24 of the 2013 Act provides transitional provisions for land acquisition proceedings initiated under the repealed 1894 Act. Section 24(2) specifies that acquisition proceedings lapse if an award under the 1894 Act was made five years or more prior to the 2013 Act, and physical possession of land is taken or compensation has not been paid.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

TaxCorp AI: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Act comes into force today

The Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Act has officially come into force, amending the parent 1969 Act. The primary objective is to prevent delays in registering births and deaths and to encourage timely registration. The Act mandates that births and deaths reported to the Registrar more than one year but within two years require executive approval. Approval for this one-to-two-year delay can be granted by a District Magistrate, Sub-Divisional Magistrate, or an Executive Magistrate. Any birth or death reported after more than two years can only be registered upon the order of a Judicial Magistrate of the First Class. The designated authority must mandatorily verify the authenticity of the reported event before granting permission for delayed registration. Registration of births and deaths remains mandatory, with the issued certificate serving to provide legal identity to individuals. The enabling legislation was passed by Parliament during the Monsoon Session in August.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Registrar, District Magistrate, Sub-Divisional Magistrate, Executive Magistrate, Judicial Magistrate of the First Class · **Prelims:** The Act amends the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969.; Delayed registrations between one and two years require approval from a District Magistrate, Sub-Divisional Magistrate, or Executive Magistrate.; Delayed registrations exceeding two years require an order from a Judicial Magistrate of the First Class.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Streamlines the civil registration database by enforcing stricter checks on delayed entries.; Enhances the evidentiary value and legal identity of birth and death certificates.*

Static — The Registration of Births and Deaths Act of 1969 regulates the registration of births and deaths across India. Civil registration in India is implemented by state governments through a unified system involving chief registrars and local registrars. Birth and death certificates are vital legal documents used for establishing identity, age, ancestry, and for claiming social security benefits.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

newsonair.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Justice Nagarathna first judge to start writing Sabarimala reference verdict

Justice BV Nagarathna has become the first judge on the nine-member Supreme Court constitution bench to start writing the judgment for the long-pending Sabarimala reference. The nine-judge bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, reserved its verdict on May 14 after 16 days of marathon hearings on constitutional questions. The ongoing reference originates from the September 2018 judgment which struck down the ban preventing women aged 10 to 50 from entering the Sabarimala temple. Subsequent review proceedings led to a larger constitutional examination concerning Articles 14, 25, and 26, the essential religious practices doctrine, and judicial review of religious freedom. Justice Nagarathna was the only woman judge on the bench and previously expressed views on the limits of the essential religious practices doctrine and the maintainability of the petition. Other members of the nine-judge bench are free to write separate opinions, and it remains unconfirmed whether Justice Nagarathna's draft will form the majority or a separate view. The verdict is expected to be pronounced before CJI Surya Kant retires on February 9, 2027.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** New Delhi / Kerala · **Who:** Justice BV Nagarathna, CJI Surya Kant · **Prelims:** The nine-judge bench hearing the Sabarimala reference was headed by CJI Surya Kant.; The original 2018 Sabarimala judgment was delivered by a 4:1 majority.; The excluded age group for women at the Sabarimala temple under the old custom was between 10 and 50 years.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It touches upon the delicate balance between constitutional morality and freedom of religion under Articles 25 and 26.; It addresses the judicial scope of the essential religious practices test.*

Static — Under Article 145(3) of the Constitution, cases involving a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution are heard by a bench of at least five judges, known as a Constitution Bench. Article 25 guarantees freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practise, and propagate religion, subject to public order, morality, and health. Article 26 grants every religious denomination the right to manage its own affairs in matters of religion.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

A.P. High Court sets aside 34% BC quota in local body polls, says it exceeds 50% overall ceiling

The Andhra Pradesh High Court struck down government orders providing 34 per cent reservation to backward castes in rural local bodies and 33.33 per cent in urban local bodies. The trigger was a batch of petitions challenging government orders GOs 105 and 1065 for violating Supreme Court guidelines on reservation limits. The core issue debated was whether exceeding the 50 per cent ceiling limit on total reservations through state-level quotas for backward classes is legally permissible. The bench comprising Chief Justice Lisa Gill announced the quashing of the government orders and ordered that local body elections must be held within six weeks. The state government defended its policy by citing a Unified Family Survey recording the BC population at 50.42 per cent and the Rajiv Ranjan Mishra Commission report. Petitioners argued that the quotas pushed total reservations for SC, ST, and BC categories beyond the 50 per cent Supreme Court ceiling. The court also dismissed a separate petition filed by YSRCP seeking to halt elections until the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls was completed.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** Andhra Pradesh · **Who:** Chief Justice Lisa Gill, Andhra Pradesh High Court, YSRCP · **Prelims:** The Andhra Pradesh High Court bench was led by Chief Justice Lisa Gill.; G.O.Ms. No.105 was issued by the Panchayat Raj Department providing 34 per

cent reservation to BCs.; G.O.Ms. No.1065 was issued by the Municipal Administration Department providing 33.33 per cent reservation to BCs.

Why it matters — *Reinforces the strict adherence to the judicial ceiling limit on reservations in local body governance.; Highlights the legal friction between state-level welfare initiatives for backward classes and constitutional jurisprudence.*

Static — Article 243-D of the Constitution mandates reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in panchayats, and empowers state legislatures to provide reservations for backward classes. The Supreme Court in the landmark 1992 Indra Sawhney case capped the total reservation quota across categories at 50 per cent, barring extraordinary circumstances. State Election Commissions are constitutional bodies established under Article 243-K to superintend, direct, and control the preparation of electoral rolls and conduct elections to panchayats and municipalities.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Judgment

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on thesouthfirst.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court orders curbs on licence renewal, vehicle registration for motorists with unpaid traffic fines

The Supreme Court directed states and Union territories to freeze vehicle-related online services where traffic fines remain unpaid. Services to be frozen include renewal of registration, issuance of fitness and pollution-under-control certificates, ownership transfers, and driving licence renewals. Vehicles with outstanding e-challans must be blacklisted on the central Parivahan portal to block their sale or transfer. The court noted that about Rs. 49,194.05 crore was outstanding against e-challans issued over time, of which Rs. 26,175.05 crore was recovered. No centre should be permitted to issue a pollution-under-control certificate until pending traffic fines are cleared. States and UTs were directed to implement the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways SOP on electronic enforcement and Section 136A of the Motor Vehicles Act. Authorities must conduct random checking and impound vehicles found with unhonoured e-challans. The bench warned the Delhi chief secretary to file a compliance report on pedestrian safety directions or face personal appearance.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court bench of justices JB Pardiwala and KV Viswanathan · **Prelims:** Total outstanding e-challans amount to Rs. 49,194.05 crore, with Rs. 26,175.05 crore recovered so far.; Section 136A of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, deals with electronic monitoring and enforcement of road safety.; Rule 167A of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules relates to electronic enforcement devices.

Why it matters — *Addresses systemic enforcement failures by moving beyond mere generation of e-challans to strict fine recovery.; Leverages digital infrastructure like the Parivahan portal and automated electronic surveillance to enforce compliance.*

Static — The Motor Vehicles Act, 1988 is the primary legislation regulating road transport vehicles in India, providing statutory backing for traffic rules, licensing, and penalties. Electronic monitoring and enforcement of road safety are governed by Section 136A of the Motor Vehicles Act, which mandates the use of electronic devices like speed cameras and CCTV. The Parivahan portal is a centralized national web portal of the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways that provides citizen-centric and transport-related services online.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Judgment, Data/Stats

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

UPSC Completes 100 Years: From 1926 Advisory Panel To Independent Constitutional Body

The Union Public Service Commission completed 100 years of its institutional journey on October 1, 2026. The journey began on October 1, 1926, with the constitution of India's first Public Service Commission as an advisory body. The core issue historically was the transition of public service entry from British colonial patronage and nomination to open merit-based competition. India's first Public Service Commission had its chairman and members appointed by the Secretary of State in London. The 1924 Lee Commission recommended the immediate establishment of a statutory Public Service Commission. Sir Ross Barker served as the first chairman of the 1926 commission, assisted by four members at Metcalfe House in Delhi. Public Service Commissions were later incorporated into Part XIV (Articles 315-323) of the Indian Constitution. Dr BR Ambedkar moved the draft articles on Public Service Commissions in the Constituent Assembly on August 22, 1949.

When: October 1, 2026 · **Where:** Delhi · **Who:** Sir Ross Barker, Dr BR Ambedkar, Satyendranath Tagore · **Prelims:** The first Public Service Commission was constituted on October 1, 1926.; Sir Ross Barker was the first chairman of the 1926 commission.; Satyendranath Tagore became the first Indian to clear the Indian Civil Service examination in 1863.

Why it matters — *Marks the historical evolution of merit-based civil service recruitment in India from colonial rule to independence.; Highlights the constitutional safeguards under Articles 315-323 ensuring impartiality and guarding against nepotism in public appointments.*

Static — Article 315 of the Constitution provides for a Public Service Commission for the Union and for each State, alongside provisions for Joint Commissions. The Union Public Service Commission conducts recruitment examinations for premier civil services, defense services, and central armed police forces in India. The Government of India Act, 1919, enacted after the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms, first provided statutory backing for establishing a Public Service Commission.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution

NDTV: read the source · *free copy on ndtv.com*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Must bring youth into public services who are not attracted to public office: PM Modi at UPSC centenary celebrations

Prime Minister Narendra Modi stated that the country must bring youth into public services who are not attracted to public office. He spoke at an event in New Delhi marking the culmination of year-long centenary celebrations of the Union Public Service Commission. He emphasized that recruitment examinations should test why a candidate wants to enter civil services rather than just testing knowledge. He highlighted the guiding mantras of citizen-first and nation-first for public servants. During the event, the Prime Minister released a commemorative coin, a stamp, and a book titled '100 Landmark Judgements'. The book released is titled '100 Landmark Judgements: Shaping the Policies of UPSC and Public Service Commissions in India'. The centenary celebrations mark 100 years since the establishment of the UPSC in the year 1926. The year-long celebrations for the UPSC centenary began on October 1, 2025.

When: October 1, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) · **Prelims:** UPSC was established in 1926, marking 100 years of existence by 2026.; The commemorative book released is titled '100 Landmark Judgements: Shaping the Policies of UPSC and Public Service Commissions in India'.; Year-long celebrations for the UPSC centenary began on October 1, 2025.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Re-emphasizes ethical foundations and citizen-centric governance in civil service recruitments.; Highlights the importance of reforming examination processes to gauge motivation and attitude.*

Static — The Union Public Service Commission is India's central recruiting agency established under Article 315 of the Constitution of India. The UPSC conducts examinations for appointments to all-India services, central services, and public sector positions as mandated. The Commission consists of a chairman and other members appointed by the President of India.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Society

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by PIB

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas Shri Hardeep Singh Puri launches GOBARdhan Scheme to accelerate development of India’s Compressed Biogas sector

Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri launched the GOBARdhan Central Sector Scheme to accelerate the Compressed Biogas sector development in India. The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on 6 August 2026 with a total financial outlay of Rs. 23,731 crore. It provides a ten-year operational framework from FY 2026–27 to FY 2035–36 to boost domestic CBG production nearly 10-fold to around 5 MMSCMD. The initiative aims to convert organic waste like crop residue and cattle dung into clean domestic energy and organic manure. A GOBARdhan Handbook and a Unified GOBARdhan Portal were also unveiled during the launch to streamline applications and enhance transparency. The scheme introduces six key interventions including CBG Offtake Assurance, a pricing framework, capital assistance, and credit guarantee support. City Gas Distribution entities face mandated procurement obligations starting at 3% for FY 2026–27, 4% for FY 2027–28, and 5% thereafter. An administered CBG price of Rs. 2,110 per MMBtu has been established to provide greater revenue visibility for producers.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas; Dr. Neeraj Mittal, Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas · **Prelims:** Financial outlay of the GOBARdhan Scheme is Rs. 23,731 crore.; The scheme provides a ten-year framework from FY 2026–27 to FY 2035–36.; Target is to increase domestic CBG production to around 5 MMSCMD.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces heavy dependence on imported natural gas by harnessing domestic agricultural and animal waste.; Boosts rural income by engaging farmers, cooperatives, and gaushalas in feedstock collection and processing.*

Static — GOBARdhan stands for Galvanizing Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan, a multi-ministerial initiative implemented to manage cattle dung and organic waste in rural areas. Compressed Biogas (CBG) is a purified and compressed form of biogas with methane content of over 90%, having properties similar to commercially available natural gas. City Gas Distribution (CGD) networks are authorized by the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) to supply piped natural gas and compressed natural gas.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · free copy on millenniumpost.in · also reported by PSU Watch, etvbharat.com

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Piyush Goyal meets EU Trade Commissioner, discusses progress on signing FTA

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met European Commissioner for Trade and Economic Security Maros Sefcovic on the sidelines of the G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting. The leaders reviewed progress towards the signing and entry into force of the India-EU Free Trade Agreement. They exchanged views on progress under the India-EU Trade and Technology Council, meaningful WTO reform, and shared G20 priorities. Earlier, Goyal spoke at a G20 session on the Weaponization of Food through Coercive Trade Action in Milwaukee, Wisconsin. He emphasized that food must remain a source of security, stability, and cooperation rather than being weaponized. Goyal also highlighted the need to distinguish between weaponizing supply chains and legitimate domestic policy measures for food security. The two-day G20 ministerial meeting was held on September 30 and October 1, hosted by the United States Trade Representative. Goyal is visiting the US from September 29 to October 5 to advance discussions on trade agreements, including an India-US Bilateral Trade Agreement.

When: September 29 to October 5, 2026 · **Where:** Milwaukee, Wisconsin, USA · **Who:** Piyush Goyal and Maros Sefcovic · **Prelims:** The G20 Trade Ministers' Meeting was held in Milwaukee, Wisconsin.; The ministerial meeting took place on September 30 and October 1.; Maros Sefcovic serves as the European Commissioner for Trade and Economic Security.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Advances bilateral trade relations and economic integration between India and the European Union.; Addresses critical global issues such as food security, supply chain resilience, and WTO reforms.*

Static — The G20 is an international forum for the governments of major developed and emerging economies, focusing on global economic issues. The World Trade Organization (WTO) is an international body dealing with the global rules of trade between nations, centered on Most-Favoured-Nation principles. Bilateral Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) aim to reduce or eliminate tariffs and non-tariff barriers to boost bilateral trade and economic integration.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on news.webindia123.com · also reported by financialexpress.com

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

AI bubble burst ‘inevitable’, India-US trade ties strained by Lindsey Graham bill, says Finance Ministry report

The release of the official Finance Ministry report highlighting risks from the Lindsey Graham Bill and global economic trends. An Indian Finance Ministry report warned that an AI investment bubble burst is inevitable and that trade ties with the US are strained by a proposed bill. India’s Finance Ministry says trade ties with the US are strained after the Lindsey Graham Bill, allowing tariffs of up to 100% on countries buying Russian crude. The report also warns of higher oil prices, bond yields, slower capital flows and an eventual AI investment slowdown.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** India, United States · **Who:** Finance Ministry, Lindsey Graham · **Prelims:** The Lindsey Graham Bill allows tariffs of up to 100% on countries buying Russian crude.; The report was issued by India's Finance Ministry.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights vulnerabilities in India-US bilateral trade relations due to secondary tariff legislation.; Signals domestic economic awareness regarding global tech sector overvaluation and capital flow risks.*

Static — Geopolitical trade restrictions often utilize secondary tariffs to penalize third-party nations engaging in trade with sanctioned countries. Artificial intelligence sector investments have experienced rapid expansion, raising concerns among economists regarding potential asset overvaluation and market correction risks. Global crude oil prices and bond yields serve as critical macroeconomic indicators impacting emerging market capital flows and currency stability.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Act/Bill/Rules

Mint: read the source

Social Justice & Welfare

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Government Strengthens Implementation of PCR and SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Acts through Special Courts, Victim Support, Awareness and Grievance Redressal Mechanisms

The Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment highlighted recent central financial releases and the setup of exclusive special courts for speedy trials. The Central Government is supporting States and UTs in implementing the PCR Act, 1955 and the SC/ST Atrocities Act, 1989 through financial assistance and special courts. The Central Government continues to support States and Union Territories in the effective implementation of the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 and the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, through a range of measures aimed at strengthening enforcement mechanisms, facilitating speedy trial, providing relief and rehabilitation to victims, creating awareness about statutory safeguards and promoting social harmony. The implementation of the two Acts primarily rests with the State Governments and Union Territory Administrations.

When: 2022-2025 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Central Government and State/UT Governments · **Prelims:** 217 Exclusive Special Courts have been established in 15 States and UTs for trial of offences under the SC/ST Act.; Total central assistance released under the Centrally Sponsored Scheme amounted to Rs. 1,423.30 crore over the financial years 2022–23, 2023–24, and 2024–25.

Why it matters — *Ensures financial backing for effective grassroots enforcement and specialized judicial infrastructure.; Aids in speedy trials and delivery of justice for victims of atrocities through Exclusive Special Courts.*

Static — The Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955, originally passed as the Untouchability (Offences) Act, 1955, penalizes the preaching and practice of untouchability in any form. The Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 was enacted to prevent atrocities against members of SCs and STs and provide for special courts for trial of such offences. The implementation and enforcement of both the PCR Act and the SC/ST Atrocities Act are primarily the responsibility of individual State Governments and UT Administrations.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source

Education

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre Launches Prime Minister Research Chair Scheme 2026 to Attract Global Indian Talent

The Central Government officially announced the launch of the Prime Minister Research Chair Scheme 2026. The Centre has launched the Prime Minister Research Chair Scheme 2026 to attract global Indian academic talent to domestic institutions.

When: 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Central Government · **Prelims:** Scheme Name: Prime Minister Research Chair Scheme 2026; Target Group: Global Indian Talent; Launch Authority: Centre / Central Government

Why it matters — *Strengthens India's domestic research and innovation ecosystem.; Encourages knowledge transfer from global institutions to Indian scholars.*

Static — Brain drain involves the emigration of trained and talented individuals from developing countries to developed nations. India has historically initiated several fellowships like the Ramanujan Fellowship and VAJRA scheme to attract diaspora experts. Premier research institutions in India include IITs, IISc, and CSIR laboratories, which often host such specialized chairs.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Education, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

DD News: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

PM-DHARA Scheme

The Union Cabinet approved the PM-DHARA scheme, standing for PM-Developing Harmonized and Accelerated Renewable-energy Access, with a total project outlay of Rs 1,86,405 crore. The scheme aims to strengthen India's Intra-State Transmission System (InSTS) to enable the evacuation of up to 135 Gigawatt of renewable energy across States and Union Territories. It provides for the deployment of 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems at generator ends or other crucial locations for grid flexibility. The implementation target for the scheme is set by the financial year 2032-33. The financial outlay comprises Rs 1,36,378 crore for InSTS development under Green Energy Corridor Phase-III and Rs 50,000 crore for Battery Energy Storage Systems. The scheme involves a total Central Financial Support amounting to Rs 54,082 crore. Greenfield projects under the InSTS component will be implemented through Tariff Based Competitive Bidding mode. Brownfield upgradation and network strengthening works will be executed on a Cost Plus Basis. State Transmission Utilities will act as the overall implementing agency, while Transmission Service Providers will participate under TBCB on a Build-Own-Operate-Maintain model.

When: FY 2032-33 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, State Transmission Utilities, Transmission Service Providers · **Prelims:** PM-DHARA stands for PM-Developing Harmonized and Accelerated Renewable-energy Access.; The total project outlay is Rs 1,86,405 crore with a Central Financial Support of Rs 54,082 crore.; The scheme targets the deployment of 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems.

Why it matters — *It helps evacuate up to 135 GW of renewable energy across various states and union territories.; It introduces 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems to ensure crucial grid flexibility.*

Static — Intra-State Transmission Systems manage the transmission of electricity within the boundaries of a single state, connecting generation sources to distribution networks. Battery Energy Storage Systems store electrical energy using batteries for later use, enhancing grid stability and managing renewable energy intermittency. Tariff Based Competitive Bidding is a mechanism used in power sectors to discover the lowest tariff transparently through competitive bidding among developers.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST collections in September again crossed Rs. 2 lakh crore

India's gross Goods and Services Tax collections crossed Rs 2 lakh crore in September 2026, rising 14.7% year-on-year to Rs 2.04 lakh crore. The revenue growth was driven by increases in both domestic transactions and import collections. Experts point out that while overall growth is strong, the sharp rise in import GST requires detailed analysis regarding raw materials versus finished goods. Revenue from domestic transactions grew 10.1% to Rs 1.38 lakh crore, while GST revenue from imports jumped 25.9% to Rs 65,525 crore. Gross Integrated GST collections reached Rs 1.20 lakh crore, Central GST stood at Rs 37,762 crore, and State GST collections were at Rs 45,363 crore. Total GST refunds declined by 3% to Rs 27,001 crore during the month, contributing to a faster growth in net revenue. Net GST collections grew 18.1% year-on-year to Rs 1.77 lakh crore, compared with Rs 1.50 lakh crore in September 2025. Gross collections for the first six months of the financial year rose 11.6% to Rs 12.46 lakh crore, led by top contributors like Maharashtra, Karnataka, and Gujarat.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Abhishek Jain · **Prelims:** Gross GST collections in September 2026 stood at Rs 2.04 lakh crore.; Maharashtra recorded the highest GST revenue among listed states at Rs 29,986 crore.; Net GST collections rose 18.1% year-on-year to Rs 1.77 lakh crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reflects robust domestic consumption and economic activity despite global headwinds.; Provides vital fiscal space for the government through steady revenue generation.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax is an indirect tax introduced in India on July 1, 2017, subsuming multiple cascading central and state taxes. The GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A, chaired by the Union Finance Minister with state finance ministers as members. IGST (Integrated GST) is levied on inter-state supplies of goods and services and on imports, collected by the Central Government.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on timesofindia.indiatimes.com · also reported by Mint

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Claude, New Yorker, Bandcamp: RBI rules leave international card payments in grey area

New RBI regulations mandate reporting for international credit card transactions, creating compliance confusion for consumers. Consumers may need to provide details on all payments for services purchased abroad, leading to potential compliance challenges. The existing framework lacks clarity on how individuals will report these transactions to banks. While international credit card purchases are part of the Liberalised Remittance Scheme, the reporting process remains unclear.

When: Starting October 1 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** New RBI rules mandate reporting of international credit card transactions.; The rules are set to start on October 1.; International credit card purchases are part of the Liberalised Remittance Scheme.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the compliance and operational challenges faced by consumers when dealing with international digital services and subscriptions.; Demonstrates the regulatory complexities involved in tracking cross-border retail transactions under existing foreign exchange frameworks.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India was established in 1935 under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, as India's central banking institution. The Liberalised Remittance Scheme permits resident individuals to remit a specified amount of foreign exchange freely abroad for permissible current or capital account transactions. Central banks regulate foreign exchange flows and international payments to maintain macroeconomic stability and comply with foreign exchange management laws.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy

Economic Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI’s success on dollar flows raises stakes in inflation fight & clamour for rate hike

A record $133 billion inflow from the Indian diaspora through FCNR(B) deposits left commercial banks awash with surplus cash. The massive dollar influx pushed overnight rates below the Reserve Bank of India's 5.25% policy rate, making borrowing cheaper than intended. Surplus banking-system liquidity swelled to as much as 11 trillion rupees ($115 billion) in September as commercial banks swapped dollars for rupees with the RBI. Keen to prevent excess liquidity from fueling price pressures, the RBI has already drained more than 1 trillion rupees through bond sales and other measures. Rising food costs and elevated oil prices are adding to inflation pressures, leading to growing market calls for an interest-rate hike. Economists at major institutions predict the RBI's first rate hike since early 2023, with markets pricing in four hikes over a one-year period. The liquidity surge and subsequent interventions pushed India's forex reserves close to $800 billion, making it the world's fourth largest. The situation illustrates the impossible trinity constraint, where managing capital flows and currency conflicts with maintaining an independent monetary policy.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** India's foreign exchange reserves moved close to $800 billion, ranking as the world's fourth largest.; Surplus banking-system liquidity swelled to as much as 11 trillion rupees ($115 billion) in September.; The Reserve Bank's policy rate mentioned in the context is 5.25%.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the practical challenges of the Mundell-Fleming trilemma for emerging market central banks managing large capital inflows.; Demonstrates how diaspora deposit schemes like FCNR(B) can successfully build foreign exchange reserves but create domestic liquidity management dilemmas.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The primary functions of the RBI include monetary management, issuing currency, regulating the banking system, and managing foreign exchange reserves. The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), established under the RBI Act, determines the policy interest rate required to achieve the inflation target.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by millenniumpost.in, Business Standard, bfsi.economictimes.indiatimes.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST Council meeting on October 7 may consider ITC relief proposals

The upcoming GST Council meeting scheduled for October 7 has brought these Law Committee proposals into focus. The GST Council is set to meet on October 7 to consider Input Tax Credit relief proposals backed by its Law Committee. Law Committee backs relief on insurance, catering, samples and write-offs

When: October 7 · **Where:** India · **Who:** GST Council, Law Committee · **Prelims:** The GST Council meeting is scheduled for October 7.; The Law Committee backed relief on insurance, catering, samples, and write-offs.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces compliance burden and litigation for businesses regarding Input Tax Credit claims.; Streamlines taxation norms on operational expenses like insurance, catering, and samples.*

Static — The GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution of India. It is chaired by the Union Finance Minister and includes ministers in charge of finance or taxation from all states. The Council makes recommendations to the Union and State governments on issues related to Goods and Services Tax.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

BusinessLine: read the source

Infrastructure & Energy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Eye on transmission bottlenecks, Cabinet clears green energy plan

The Union Cabinet approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) to evacuate up to 135 gigawatts of renewable energy across States by FY 2032-33. For the first time, the GEC programme will fund battery storage alongside transmission lines to prevent solar power wastage due to grid capacity limits. Grid operators are forced to curtail solar generation because transmission lines cannot carry peak power demand, risking project viability. Close to 21 gigawatts of installed renewable capacity runs on temporary grid connections awaiting dedicated transmission lines. In FY 2025-26, around 6,900 gigawatt-hours of clean electricity faced restrictions because renewable capacity grew faster than transmission. The total scheme outlay is Rs 1,86,405 crore, with the Centre providing Rs 54,082 crore as central financial assistance to offset intra-State transmission charges. The scheme includes 50 gigawatt-hours of Battery Energy Storage Systems with an outlay of Rs 50,000 crore, and intra-State transmission lines with Rs 1,36,378 crore. Greenfield lines will be awarded through Tariff Based Competitive Bidding, while brownfield upgrades will run on a Cost Plus Basis. Key challenges include right-of-way clearances, weak State utility finances, battery import dependence, and timeline mismatches.

When: FY 2032-33 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, State transmission utilities, renewable energy developers · **Prelims:** GEC-III targets the evacuation of up to 135 gigawatts of renewable energy.; The total scheme outlay is Rs 1,86,405 crore with Rs 54,082 crore as central financial assistance.; The scheme includes 50 gigawatt-hours of Battery Energy Storage Systems with an outlay of Rs 50,000 crore.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It shifts India's renewable energy strategy from merely adding generation capacity to effectively moving and storing produced power.; It supports the national target of achieving 900 GW of non-fossil capacity by 2035 by ensuring grid stability and financial viability for developers.*

Static — The Green Energy Corridor (GEC) programme was initiated to facilitate the evacuation of renewable power from generation stations to load centres by laying intra-state and inter-state transmission systems. Tariff Based Competitive Bidding (TBCB) is a mechanism where transmission service providers bid for projects based on the lowest tariff quoted, promoting private sector participation. Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) enable power to be stored and discharged at a later time, helping grid operators manage the intermittency of renewable energy sources.

Syllabus: GS3: Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy

civilsdaily.com: read the source · also reported by ET Government

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Indian Navy to induct record 18 warships in 2026, marking largest single-year force expansion in its history

The Indian Navy plans to induct or commission a record 18 warships in the year 2026, marking the largest single-year force expansion in its history. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh announced this milestone while addressing the second edition of the Indian Navy's biannual Commander's Conference 2026 in New Delhi. The expansion reflects the growing maturity, capability, and self-reliance of India's domestic naval shipbuilding ecosystem. Recently commissioned warships contain over 75 percent indigenous content, showcasing major advances in domestic defence manufacturing. The Defence Minister called for a significant upgrade of India's maritime surveillance architecture to handle growing maritime traffic complexity. Mr Singh emphasized that the Indian Navy acts as a strategic anchor for the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision by ensuring economic protection and regional stability. The Navy was commended for maintaining high combat readiness and fulfilling regional commitments despite evolving geopolitical challenges.

When: 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Rajnath Singh · **Prelims:** Year of planned record induction: 2026; Number of warships to be inducted: 18; Indigenous content in recently commissioned warships: Over 75 percent

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the success of domestic defense manufacturing, with recently commissioned ships featuring over 75% indigenous content.; Enhances India's power projection and maritime surveillance capabilities in the strategic Indian Ocean Region.*

Static — The Indian Navy is the naval branch of the Indian Armed Forces, with the President of India serving as its Supreme Commander. The force is headed by the Chief of the Naval Staff (CNS), a four-star Admiral based at the Integrated Headquarters in New Delhi. India's naval shipbuilding relies heavily on domestic public sector shipyards like Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders, Garden Reach Shipbuilders, and Cochin Shipyard.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence

newsonair.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

BrahMos missile system to see over USD 600 million exports, is benchmark for India's emerging export story: Defence Secretary

Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh stated that BrahMos missile exports are set to cross USD 600 million. Contracts or agreements are in place to sell the strategic missile system to three Southeast Asian countries including Philippines, Indonesia, and Vietnam. BrahMos serves as a key benchmark for India's growing defence export story and international market integration. The Philippines has received BrahMos missile deliveries valued at approximately USD 330 million. Initial exports to Vietnam are expected to be around USD 100 million, while Indonesia's deals should reach about USD 200 million. The missile system features an air-launched version that has seen great success on Sukhoi fighter jets. India's overall defence exports reached an all-time high of Rs 38,424 crore in the Financial Year 2025-26. Defence Public Sector Undertakings and the private sector contributed 54.84% and 45.16% respectively to the total defence exports.

When: 2026-10-01 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Rajesh Kumar Singh (Defence Secretary) · **Prelims:** BrahMos exports are projected to cross USD 600 million.; Deliveries to the Philippines are valued at about USD 330 million.; Total Indian defence exports reached Rs 38,424 crore in FY 2025-26.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's transition from a major defence importer to an emerging global defence exporter.; Demonstrates the growing reliability and global acceptance of indigenous strategic defence systems like BrahMos.*

Static — BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile jointly developed by India's DRDO and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya under the joint venture BrahMos Aerospace. It is named after two rivers, the Brahmaputra in India and the Moskva in Russia, and operates on a 'fire-and-forget' principle. BrahMos is one of the fastest anti-ship cruise missiles in operation globally, capable of being launched from ships, submarines, aircraft, and land platforms.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Economy

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Special Gram Sabhas across India to Mark 2nd October with Discussions on Transformative Governance Reforms ; Launch People's Plan Campaign 2026-27 'Sabki Yojana, Sabka Vikas'

Special Gram Sabhas are being convened across India to discuss governance reforms and launch the People's Plan Campaign 2026-27 for grassroots planning. Special Gram Sabhas across the country will assemble on 2nd October 2026 to discuss transformative governance reforms and initiatives that are strengthening Panchayats, improving public services and enhancing the quality of life in rural India.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Tamil Nadu CM Vijay launches Vettri Payanam scheme, expanding no-fare bus travel for women

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Vijay rolled out the expanded Vetri Payanam free bus scheme for women on October 2. The expansion builds on the existing free travel for women in ordinary buses within metropolitan and urban areas. The updated scheme now includes Express, LSS, and Deluxe buses in metropolitan and urban areas. It also covers ordinary suburban buses between districts and ordinary buses in hill areas beyond 40 kilometres.

Times of India: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Bihar Cabinet gives nod to Bihar Green Hydrogen Policy, 2026

The Bihar state cabinet approved the Bihar Green Hydrogen Policy, 2026, aimed at promoting renewable energy and reducing carbon emissions. The policy was cleared during a cabinet meeting chaired by CM Samrat Choudhary to attract private investments and cut imported gas dependence. The policy targets an annual production of 10 lakh tonnes of green hydrogen, drawing investments worth Rs 16,000 crore.

The Hindu: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

NHRC, India takes suomotu cognizance of report on 12-member Uttar Pradesh family allegedly kept as bonded labourers for nearly a year at a construction facility in Medchal-Malkajgiri district, Telangana

A media report published on 30th September 2026 highlighted the alleged exploitation and rescue of the 12-member family in Medchal-Malkajgiri district. The National Human Rights Commission took suo motu cognizance of a media report about a 12-member UP family kept as bonded labourers at a Telangana construction site.

PIB: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

NPCIL & Gujarat Sign MoU to Identify Sites for New Nuclear Power Plants

NPCIL and GSECL signed a Memorandum of Understanding on October 1, 2026, to explore and identify suitable nuclear power project sites in Gujarat. The agreement was signed to assess Gujarat's potential for future nuclear power development and expand reliable, clean electricity generation. The core issue is expanding India's low-carbon energy infrastructure to meet growing power needs while achieving the 2070 net-zero target.

indianmasterminds.com: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Forward-Looking Survey on Private Corporate Sector CAPEX Investment Intentions

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation announced the launch and operational details of the CAPEX 2026 survey. The National Statistics Office (NSO) is conducting the Forward-Looking Survey on Private Corporate Sector CAPEX Investment Intentions (CAPEX 2026) from October to December 2026 to track corporate investment trends.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Agreement Signed between DBN (Digital Bharat Nidhi) - Department of Telecommunications; Government of Maharashtra; MDIL; BSNL & MahaIT for Implementation of Amended BharatNet Program in Maharashtra

In a significant step towards strengthening digital infrastructure and accelerating broadband connectivity across rural Maharashtra, Digital Bharat Nidhi (DBN) under Department of Telecommunications (DoT) signed an Agreement for implementation of the Amended BharatNet Program (ABP) in the State under the State-led model today at Sanchar Bhawan, New Delhi.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Government of India Revises Guidelines for Issuance of Exempted FASTags for Divyangjan and PwD Vehicles

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways revised guidelines for the issuance and renewal of exempted FASTags for Divyangjan and PwD vehicles. The new rules aim to simplify toll-related procedures, promote ease of living, and reduce the need for repeated procedural formalities. The revised guidelines will come into effect from October 2, 2026.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

RBI issues Amendment Directions on ‘Simplified approval process for subsequent acquisitions of major shareholding in a banking company by mutual funds, insurance companies and pension funds’

The RBI formally released these amendment directions through an official press release. The Reserve Bank of India issued amendment directions introducing a simplified approval process for mutual funds, insurance companies, and pension funds making subsequent acquisitions of major shareholding in banking companies.

RBI: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

Stealth frigate INS Trishul takes part in bilateral naval exercise 'Varuna' in France

The Indian Navy's stealth frigate INS Trishul participated in the 24th edition of the bilateral naval exercise 'Varuna' in France. The exercise was held from September 22 to 28 to strengthen maritime ties and professional bonds between the two navies. INS Trishul arrived in Toulon, France, on September 22 and received a warm ceremonial water cannon salute from the French Navy.

Economic Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

DDWS Organizes Second Follow-up Meeting to accelerate drinking water coverage in tribal areas under PM-JANMAN and DA-JGUA

The meeting was convened to review progress on commitments made by States and Union Territories to saturate eligible tribal villages with drinking water.

PIB: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Consolidation/ Review of instructions issued on currency management matters

RBI/2026-27/274 DCM (IFCD).No.S2096/06.08.002/2026-27 October 1, 2026 The Chairman / Managing Director / Chief Executive Officer All Banks Madam / Dear Sir, Consolidation/ Review of instructions issued on currency management matters – Withdrawal of Circulars/ Guidelines In pursuance of the Reserve Bank's ongoing initiative to rationalise the regulatory framework, a review of instructions issued on currency management related matters has been undertaken.

RBI: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Jal Jeevan Mission unites J&K Assembly as House worries over stalled schemes

Legislators in the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly cutting across party lines expressed concern that recommendations of a House committee report on Jal Jeevan Mission could hamper safe drinking water delivery. Hasnain Masoodi, chairman of the House committee, tabled a report recommending the audit of all 3,253 water supply schemes under the Rs 11,000 crore Jal Jeevan Mission in J&K.

theprint.in: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE DAY/OBSERVANCE QUICK READ

Dr. Virendra Kumar, Shri B L Verma To Distribute Assistive Devices Among Senior Citizens On Swachh Bharat Diwas Tomorrow

The distribution programme is organized on the occasion of Swachh Bharat Diwas. Union Ministers Dr. Virendra Kumar and Shri B. L. Verma will distribute free assistive devices worth over Rs. 10 lakh to 114 senior citizens under the Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana.

PIB: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE QUICK READ

Kin of Manipur's 49 people missing since 2023 ethnic conflict to get Rs. 10 lakh each

The Manipur government approved a one-time special humanitarian assistance of Rs 10 lakh each to the next of kin of 49 missing persons. These individuals have remained untraced following ethnic violence that began in the state on May 3, 2023. The decision was taken during a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Govt considers cutting import duties on pulses to cool prices: Report

A weak monsoon has raised concerns over domestic pulse output, prompting the government to explore duty cuts. The Indian government is considering a cut in import duties on lentils and yellow peas to increase domestic supplies and control food inflation. India may cut import duties on lentils and yellow peas to boost supplies and curb food inflation as weak monsoon raises concerns over domestic pulse output

Business Standard: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India, Canada Reset Ties: CEPA Talks Launched, Energy and Defence Deals Signed

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney agreed to reset and deepen bilateral relations during an official visit to India. The visit marked the first bilateral trip by a Canadian prime minister to India since 2018 and coincided with 79 years of diplomatic relations. The core issue centers on rebuilding diplomatic, economic, and security ties following prior strains, anchoring the partnership around mutual democratic values and sovereignty.

ddnews.gov.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION QUICK READ

Declaration part of Form 6 changed since SIR in Bihar

The change in the declaration part of Form 6 was highlighted by ECI officials following developments in the SIR process in Bihar. Election Commission officials stated that a separate declaration form associated with Form 6 and Form 8 was approved and implemented starting from the SIR process in Bihar.

The Hindu: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

Union cabinet approves Rs 8,398 crore Vizhinjam ORR; EC clearance granted

The Union cabinet has granted environmental clearance for the proposed Rs 8,398 crore Greenfield Outer Ring Road connecting Vizhinjam and Navaikulam. The clearance follows uncertainties and delays, and as many as 6,500 parties who surrendered land had approached the High Court seeking intervention. The core issue involves balancing large-scale infrastructure development with mitigating severe biodiversity loss and environmental degradation across sensitive zones.

newindianexpress.com: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Chhattisgarh and ASI Sign MoU to Strengthen Heritage Tourism

The Department of Culture in the Chhattisgarh government signed a Memorandum of Understanding with the Archaeological Survey of India. The partnership aims to systematically plan and develop visitor amenities and public infrastructure across centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites. Comprehensive development blueprints will be drafted in close consultation with ASI officials to enrich tourist experiences.

newindianexpress.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

SCO consensus driven: MEA amid reports of India blocking Turkey's membership | SCO presently has 10 permanent member states

The MEA issued this clarification amid media reports claiming India opposed or blocked Turkey's entry into the SCO. The Ministry of External Affairs clarified that decisions within the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation are consensus driven, following reports that India blocked Turkey's membership.

Inshorts: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India-Brazil Eye Economic Pact, Defence Ties Amid G20 Trade Talks

The talks are taking place during ongoing G20 trade discussions where bilateral meetings between Indian and Brazilian delegations were held. India and Brazil are discussing a potential economic partnership agreement and enhanced defence ties on the sidelines of G20 trade talks.

Asianet Newsable: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Employers face compliance hurdles as states delay notification of Labour Code rules

The ongoing delay by states in formalizing the rules has reignited concerns among employers regarding operational uncertainties. Employers are experiencing compliance challenges due to delays by various state governments in notifying rules associated with the new Labour Codes.

The Economic Times: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

SpintronicsAI, CSIR-CEERI partner on indigenous GaN semiconductor technology

The signing of the Memorandum of Understanding between SpintronicsAI and CSIR-CEERI put the partnership in the news. SpintronicsAI and CSIR-CEERI have signed an MoU to collaborate on advancing indigenous Gallium Nitride semiconductor technology.

thehindubusinessline.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

PM Narendra Modi likely to attend US G20 as India-US trade agreement and Russia sanctions loom

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is likely to lead India's delegation for the G20 Leaders' Summit in Miami, Florida on December 14 and 15. Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney stated that negotiations for a CEPA between India and Canada are expected to conclude around the G20. Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal met US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer in Milwaukee to push for an interim trade agreement.

cnbctv18.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 Why you can sue your doctor in consumer court, not your lawyer

On September 9, a five-judge bench of the Supreme Court dismissed a curative petition in Medico Legal Society of India v. Bar of Indian Lawyers & Ors. The dismissal closed the final procedural resort to reconsider the 2024 ruling that lawyers do not fall within the Consumer Protection Act. The author argues that an asymmetric legal gap exists where wronged patients can approach consumer forums, while wronged legal clients cannot.

ThePrint

GS2 The Act notification veto: When 'when' quietly becomes 'never'

Parliament passes a law and the President signs it, but the executive fails to issue a notification to commence it, leaving the statute dead on arrival. This phenomenon, termed a notification veto, allows the government to indefinitely delay or refuse the implementation of statutes without judicial or legislative interference. Prominent examples include the Delhi Rent Act of 1995 and the Whistleblowers Protection Act of 2014, which remain uncommenced decades after enactment.

Bar & Bench

GS2 Trump’s vanity summit with Xi

The editorial appears in the context of commentary on high-level US-China diplomatic interactions. An opinion piece analyzing the diplomatic summit between Donald Trump and Xi Jinping as a vanity project lacking substantive outcomes.

Financial Express

GS3 Is the RBI’s inflation formula helping or hurting you?

It is in the news due to ongoing debates regarding India's monetary policy and diverse inflation pressures. An editorial discussing whether the Reserve Bank of India's inflation management formula effectively serves the public amid diverse economic challenges. India’s great monetary balancing act is tested by diverse inflation challenges

BusinessLine

GS3 Trump’s trade war was just the start. The next fight can be over capital

Rich countries may soon restrict the international movement of capital, following recent curbs on people and trade. The main trigger is in the US, where growing corporate borrowings for the AI and tech race clash with a rising budget deficit. US corporate bond issuances grew 80 per cent in two years, and the federal deficit reached 7 per cent of GDP. Foreign holdings of marketable US treasuries dropped to 30 per cent from 50 per cent in 2015 as China and Japan reduce exposure.

ThePrint

GS2 GS3 America’s Lindsey Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act reflects much of what’s wrong with today’s war-ravaged world

The introduction of the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act by US lawmaker Lindsey Graham put third-party trade risks and India's energy security in focus. The editorial examines the implications of America's proposed Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which threatens third-party nations with penalties for trading with specified countries. It's a rare case of third parties at risk of penalties for trading with specified countries despite no formal declaration of war against them.

Mint

GS2 Connecting India’s disability welfare ecosystem

India's disability welfare system features parallel central and state programmes rather than integrated ones, leading to administrative silos. The core goal is ensuring timely access to assistive technology and support services for persons with disabilities and senior citizens. Central schemes like ADIP and RVY operate alongside state initiatives like Tamil Nadu's advanced assistive devices programme and Divyang Sahara Yojana. Overlap is significant, with nine of the 15 major categories distributed by Tamil Nadu also provided under the central ADIP scheme.

ThePrint

GS1 GS2 India’s elderly women need better social security cover

India is experiencing a feminisation of ageing, with older persons projected to reach 20.8% of the population by 2050 and women outnumbering men. Nearly 54% of elderly women outlive their partners, and they typically face higher morbidities, poorer nutrition, and basic physical challenges compared to men. A vast majority of older women are uneducated and lack assets, with 68.2% of women aged 60-75 being illiterate and heavily dependent on families.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Taking stock of IRDAI’s distribution reset

The ongoing regulatory changes and distribution reset by IRDAI in the insurance sector. An editorial analyzing the IRDAI's distribution reset and arguing that insurers must transparently pass on expense savings to policyholders via premium revisions and bonuses. Insurers should report how expense savings are passed on, through premium revisions and bonus declarations

BusinessLine

GS2 GS3 AI rules cannot be a US-China duopoly

The US and China have established a Super Intelligence Dialogue and agreed on a bilateral communication channel for AI incidents. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Vice Premier He Lifeng laid the groundwork through eight hours of talks in New York. The central debate is that a bilateral hotline lacks a shared definition of an AI incident and a clear threshold for use. President Trump has responded with an AI Force and an AI czar while calling alarms a hoax, whereas President Xi advocates human control.

tribuneindia.com

GS3 BRICS isn't killing the dollar. The world is learning to live without it

The ongoing shift toward local currency settlements in energy trade, particularly among Russia, China, and India, has put the topic in the news. The editorial discusses how BRICS nations are reducing their reliance on the US dollar by promoting trade in national currencies like the rouble, renminbi, and rupee. BRICS aims to decrease reliance on the US dollar by facilitating trade in national currencies among member countries.

Economic Times

GS3 Can Essar's planned steelmaking project in America count on Trump's policies outlasting his power?

The initiative aligns with Donald Trump's call for domestic steel production, raising questions about long-term policy durability. An opinion piece analyzes the viability and political risks of Essar's planned steelmaking project in the United States. The Indian industrial group's return to steelmaking with a project in the US would be in sync with Trump's call to make this metal in America again. Yet, what looks like a win-win for Trump and Essar might be over-exposed to policy risks.

Mint

GS3 Best of BS Opinion: After trade policy clashes, is a capital war imminent?

It was featured in the Business Standard opinion compilation highlighting ongoing global and domestic economic discussions. An overview of recent opinion pieces examining structural shifts such as trade policy clashes, capital wars, demographic changes, and technological impacts. From India's narrowing demographic window and Boeing 737 MAX safety concerns to capital-flow risks, Carrefour's return and AI's social costs, today's opinions examine long-term structural shifts

Business Standard

GS2 GS3 Disaster relief is not a favour from Delhi

India loses Rs 1.32 lakh crore annually to extreme weather, yet national and state disaster response funds released only Rs 11,500 crore in 2024. Climate finance in India heavily favors renewable energy and transport while critical sectors like agriculture, forests, water, and waste remain underfunded. Current safety nets such as PM Fasal Bima and Kisan Samman aid land-owning farmers, leaving agricultural labourers and construction workers without a safety net.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Opinion: Opinion | 'Lies, Damned Lies, Statistics': On The Controversy Around India's GDP Growth Figures

The government announced a real GDP growth rate of 7.8% for the first quarter of 2026, which sparked intense debate among independent economists. Scepticism regarding India's growth metrics stems from a decade-long erosion of trust following demonetisation, GST, and the dissolution of the statistical advisory body in 2024. A key part of the current controversy involves transitioning to a new base year of 2022-23 and retroactively shrinking the previous year's baseline.

NDTV

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

India-EFTA Trade & Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) The India-EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement is a comprehensive trade deal signed between India and the four EFTA member countries on March 10, 2024. The agreement entered into force on October 1, 2025, to promote free trade, economic integration, and bilateral investment between India and the European nations.

ForumIAS

What did the Supreme Court say about preventive detention based on custodial confession? The Supreme Court ruled that a confession made by an accused before a police officer cannot form the basis for preventive detention under the National Security Act. The bench held that such a confession, without independent supporting material, fails to constitute the 'subjective satisfaction' required to sustain a detention order.

The Hindu

What is source apportionment in air-pollution management? How can it improve the effectiveness of urban clean-air strategies in India? Source apportionment is a scientific method connecting measured ambient pollution with its specific contributing emission sources. It provides a robust evidence base for policymakers to make informed pollution-control decisions. The core purpose is to identify and quantify the relative contributions of various pollution sources using scientific approaches.

Insights on India

Why Kerala's groundwater is increasingly at risk of contamination Growing concerns over water safety, inadequate sanitation infrastructure, and health impacts in Kerala have put groundwater contamination in focus. Kerala's groundwater is facing heightened contamination risks due to heavy dependence, dense settlements, poor sewerage, and erratic rainfall.

The Hindu

Explained | What is Minimum Support Price (MSP)? The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved higher Minimum Support Prices for all mandated rabi crops for the 2027-28 marketing season. The decision aims to incentivize cultivators to adopt modern technology and boost productivity to achieve food grain self-sufficiency.

onmanorama.com

Can a police confession justify NSA detention? What Supreme Court said in Sambhal case The matter came into focus following legal challenges against NSA detentions ordered in Sambhal that relied on police-recorded statements. The Supreme Court examined the legal validity of utilizing police confessions as the basis for ordering preventive detention under the National Security Act in the Sambhal case.
Indian Express

Gen-2 joined green crackers The Supreme Court allowed the manufacture and sale of specified next-generation joined green firecrackers ahead of the festive season. The decision followed submissions by the Centre that joined crackers complying with CSIR-NEERI standards could be permitted. Only products meeting specified formulation, emission, noise and safety requirements are permitted, while barium-containing crackers remain under consideration.
The Hindu

Why India's new fuel-efficiency norms a missed opportunity The introduction and public scrutiny of the CAFE-3 framework and its alternative technology provisions. India's new CAFE-3 carbon emission framework has sparked debate for allegedly providing automakers with regulatory loopholes.
The Hindu

Super Intelligence and Trump's AI Accord with Big Tech leaders Donald Trump signed the White House Accord on Super Intelligence with leaders of the artificial intelligence industry. The agreement leaves the moral task of regulating AI agents entirely on companies without external government intervention. The official White House document contained a major misspelling, typing President of the Unites States instead of United States.
The Hindu

Knowledge Nugget: Why Green Energy Corridor Phase-III matters for India's renewable energy push The explainer highlights the strategic importance of Green Energy Corridor Phase-III for grid integration. An explainer examining the role of Green Energy Corridor Phase-III in supporting India's renewable energy targets.
Indian Express

Embraer C-390 Millennium explained: Key specifications and capabilities of the Brazilian military transport aircraft Embraer and Mahindra have proposed Nagpur as the location for a final assembly line for the C-390 Millennium aircraft in India. The project depends on the aircraft being selected for the Indian Air Force's Medium Transport Aircraft programme to replace the ageing An-32 fleet.
Economic Times

Why India needs more transmission, battery storage for green energy push The Union Cabinet approved the PM-DHARA Scheme to strengthen India's Intra-State Transmission System and evacuate up to 135 GW of renewable energy. Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw stated that renewable energy accounts for 52 percent of India's power generation capacity exceeding 500 gigawatts.
msn.com

Mint Explainer | RoSCTL extended: What it means for apparel exporters The extension of the RoSCTL scheme for apparel exporters put it in the news. The RoSCTL scheme has been extended to help Indian apparel exporters offset embedded domestic taxes and stay competitive.
Mint

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Economic outlook faces upside inflation risks, says Finmin report (Economy) BusinessLine
- Geopolitical tensions, high crude may fuel India's imported inflation, says government report (Economy) Hindustan Times
- HEADQUARTERS INTEGRATED DEFENCE STAFF CELEBRATES 25 YEARS OF JOINTNESS AND INTEGRATION (Defence) PIB
- NMMSS Scholarship Application Deadline Extended to October 31, 2026 (Education) PIB
- Export schemes extended amid West Asia crisis (Economy) Economic Times
- Sadhana Shrinkhla: First Regional Workshop on Mission Karmayogi Concludes at Vijayawada (Governance & Policy) PIB
- LEGAL NEWS REPORT NO. 02: SUPREME COURTS 2020 RULING UPHELD SECTION 18A OF THE SC/ST ACT (Social Justice & Welfare) AIMA Media
- Cooperation between the Nalanda University and the CSIR-Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (CSIR-TKDL) Unit for research and capacity-building in the areas of Traditional Knowledge (TK), Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), People's Rights and Cultural Heritage (History, Art & Culture) PIB
- JK govt notifies Electric Vehicle Policy 2026 (Environment & Ecology) BusinessLine
- Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code has strengthened credit discipline, improved recovery climate and contributed to ease of doing business: Harsh Malhotra, MoS, Corporate Affairs Ministry (Economy) PIB
- Photos: Kashmir's Dal Lake faces environmental and climate challenges (Environment & Ecology) Al Jazeera
- Telangana scientists discover two new gecko species (Environment & Ecology) hyderabadmail.com
- Keralam government to formulate draft Bill for setting up Tribal University in Wayanad (Education) The Hindu

- Distinguish food weaponisation from security measures: Goyal at G20 meet (Economy) Business Standard
- Regulation, Market Reforms Key to Strengthening India's Energy Security: NITI Aayog Member Rajiv Gauba (Infrastructure & Energy) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- UAE FTA engages BRICS leaders to strengthen global tax cooperation (Economy) GulfToday
- ECINET, ERONET explained: How Election Commission's voter roll systems work (Polity & Constitution) Business Standard
- Pakistan stresses diplomacy, SCO engagement, rejects India's claims on Indus Waters Treaty (International Relations) | Associated Press Of Pakistan
- Pakistan's Foreign Minister Dar reviews preparations for 2027 SCO summit (International Relations) UA.NEWS
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COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 21 must-know, 25 Prelims facts, 53 in the news, 15 editorials, 13 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (9), Economy (9), Governance & Policy (8), International Relations (6), Social Justice & Welfare (4), Defence (3), Infrastructure & Energy (3), Education (1), Environment & Ecology (1), History, Art & Culture (1), Science & Technology (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 1 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 3

Full text — 41 of 74 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 11, PIB 9, Economic Times 7, Mint 4, BusinessLine 4, Hindustan Times 3, ThePrint 3, newsonair.gov.in 2, NDTV 2, RBI 2, Business Standard 2, newindianexpress.com 2, Indian Express 2, TaxCorp AI 1

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